

Cirqlback Arcade — Linear Plan (v2)

The restructured **Main Street Arcade** Linear project, issue by issue. Mirrors the v2 Master Plan & Guide. Grouped by phase; each issue lists its Definition of Done. Freestyle is retired for this line; Daily, avatar-hero, music, and "update plan + push to Render" are baked into every cabinet.

Project overview

Project: Main Street Arcade (Cirqlback Arcade v2) · Team CHR

Goal: one unified pixel/CRT arcade housing the 57 circular games + 10 new 16-bit shop-themed cabinets, sharing one avatar, one Daily/leaderboard/reward spine.

Locked decisions: 16-bit tier · unified front door · avatar stars in every cabinet · free-play quarter · all cabinets open · circular line pixel-reskinned.

Phase 0 · Foundation (epic: CHR-180)

The platform layer, built once. The avatar rig gates the cabinets, so it lands first.

Foundation issues

- **RetroEngine — 16-bit tier** · pixel buffer + nearest-neighbor upscale, `shade()` / `mix()` / `vgrad()` / `shelf()` / `ball()` draw kit, bundled 3×5 font, toggleable CRT, fixed-timestep, d-pad/tap/two-thumb input, `gameId` backend reuse.
 - **MusicKit** · layered chiptune (square lead+harmony, triangle bass, noise drums), theme + boss variant + game-over jingle, dynamic layering, shared Main Street leitmotif, respects mute.
 - **Avatar system + customizer** · "little people & toys" figure; body/skin/eyes/expression/hair/hat/outfit/accessory/sidekick; per-shop outfit rig + play-to-unlock hooks; renders in lobby, cutscene, leaderboards, and as the in-game hero.
 - **Insert-Coin cutscene** · reusable 16-bit hand-drops-quarter → boot → marquee → PRESS START; skippable after first view; attract/demo mode on the lobby.
 - **Unified pixel lobby** · category rail (Action/Puzzle/Arcade/Classic/Reflex/Strategy/Zen), player-profile card, game cards, bottom nav; light pixel reskin of the circular line.
 - **Leaderboards & rewards wiring** · Daily + all-time per game, reward events (first play, streak, clears, boss kills, PBs), cosmetics/perks payout, server-side score validation.
 - **Mobile & a11y baseline** · portrait handling + on-screen two-thumb controls, colorblind-safe palettes, reduced-motion, CRT toggle, assist difficulty.
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Phase 1 · The 10 cabinets

Each cabinet is one issue and must meet the full Definition of Done before it ships. **After each: update the plan + Linear and push to Render.**

Definition of Done (applies to every cabinet issue)

- ☐ Extends RetroEngine (16-bit); round hero with `ball()` shading
- ☐ 3 worlds · ~20–40 progressive levels · boss cadence · new mechanic per world
- ☐ Signature twist implemented and fun
- ☐ Juice pass (shake, particles, hitstop, combo popups, transitions)
- ☐ Avatar is the playable hero + shop outfit unlock wired
- ☐ Original music (theme + boss variant + game-over jingle, dynamic layering)
- ☐ Insert-Coin cutscene wired (skippable)
- ☐ Daily challenge (fixed seed) + leaderboard submit + reward events
- ☐ Two-thumb mobile controls + portrait + reduced-motion
- ☐ tsc clean, verified in-browser, lazy-routed in lobby
- ☐ Plan + Linear updated and pushed to Render

Cabinet issues

- ☐ **CHR-181 · Cuppa Rush** (Coffee · Tapper) — POC. Physics mugs + bank-shots; boss "regulars" order combos. Worlds: Morning Rush → Lunch Crowd → Late Night.
- ☐ **CHR-182 · Slice Route** (Pizza · Paperboy) — Branching streets (route forks = risk/reward); weather worlds. Suburbs → Downtown → Boardwalk.
- ☐ **CHR-190 · Spin Cycle** (Laundromat · Puzzle Bobble) — Rotating-drum bubble grid; suds hazards; bleach color-bomb. Wash → Spin → Dry.
- ☐ **CHR-184 · Rummage** (Thrift · Pac-Man) — Reshuffling rack-maze; outfit power-ups (speed/disguise/magnet). Racks → Fitting Rooms → Storeroom.
- ☐ **CHR-185 · Dozen** (Donut · Q*bert) — Color-mix glazes (multi-hop targets); conveyor crates. Counter → Kitchen → Loading Dock.
- ☐ **CHR-187 · Sundae Stack** (Ice-cream · Tetris) — Flavor-match combos + line-clears; per-level sundae goals; brain-freeze rows.
- ☐ **CHR-186 · Fresh Batch** (Bakery · Donkey Kong) — Grab-and-throw rolling pins; destructible obstacles; top-shelf bonuses. Ovens → Cooling Racks → Rooftop.
- ☐ **CHR-189 · Taco Stack** (Taqueria · BurgerTime) — Lime = weapon + combo; spicy meter; order-ticket priority. Truck → Cantina → Fiesta.
- ☐ **CHR-188 · Spin City** (Record · Marble Madness) — The record plays the track; tempo = time pressure; groove rails. 45s → LPs → Live Set.
- ☐ **CHR-183 · Fix-It** (Hardware · Fix-It Felix Jr.) — Adaptive wrecker; power-tool upgrades; renovation bonus rounds. Apartments → Offices → Penthouse.

(Recommended build order: Cuppa Rush → Slice Route → Spin Cycle first, to prove the range early.)

Phase 2 · Meta & polish

- **Achievements/badges** — auto thresholds per cabinet (Badge Phase 2).
 - **Avatar cosmetic-unlock catalog** + reward **skin packs** a business can hand out.
 - **Sponsorship/skin hooks** — a shop adopts its matching cabinet + attaches a perk.
 - **Social** — share score/avatar card; race the Daily #1 ghost.
 - **Seasonal** — limited-time skins; rotating cabinet-of-the-week.
 - **A11y & performance pass** across all cabinets.
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Milestones

- **M0** — Foundation + Cuppa Rush end-to-end.
- **M1** — First 3 cabinets live + lobby unified.
- **M2** — All 10 cabinets live.
- **M3** — Meta & polish complete.